Ford Motor Company

December 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 00S46 : Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year Explorer and Mountaineer Vehicles – Powertrain Calibration Update

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 1999 and 2000 model year Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles equipped with 4.0L SOHC engines, with the axle and tire combinations listed below, built through November 23, 1999, at the Louisville and St. Louis Assembly Plants.

- 3.27 axle ratio equipped with P235/75/R15 or P225/70/R15
- 3.55 axle ratio equipped with P235/75/R15
- 3.73 axle ratio equipped with P255/70/R16 tires *

* Axle Ratio and Tire combination is not used in North America (Export Only)

SAFETY CONCERN

Ford Motor has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exist in certain 1999 and 2000 model year Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles, built through November 23, 1999 at the Louisville and St. Louis Assembly Plants. Although Ford does not advocate driving at vehicle maximum speed, the subject vehicles have a Powertrain Control Module (PCM) that may allow the vehicle to exceed the design intent top speed. At these extreme speeds, the vehicle may be capable of exceeding the speed rating of the tires. Operating the vehicle above the tire maximum speed rating could lead to tire failure which at these extreme speeds could potentially result in an accident. Therefore, we are recommending that vehicles be returned to dealerships to have their Powertrain Control Module (PCM) updated with a revised calibration that will limit vehicle top speed to the intended design level.

SERVICE ACTION

The Powertrain Control Module (PCM) will be reprogrammed to limit vehicle speed to the intended design maximum speed.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 00S46

Certain 1999 and 2000 Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles equipped with 4.0L SOHC engines
Powertrain Calibration Update

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
  - Program Code 00S46
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Refunds do not apply to this program.

RENTAL CARS

Rental cars are not included in this program.

Safety Recall 00S46
Certain 1999 and 2000 Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles equipped with 4.0L SOHC engines
Powertrain Calibration Update

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Unable to reprogram Powertrain Control Module (PCM) – latest level already installed	00S46A	0.3 Hours
Reprogram Powertrain Control Module	00S46B	0.4 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hours

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Part Number	Description	Quantity
FPS-8262	Authorized Modification Label*	1

* Label orders come in packages of 25 and are provided at no charge

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

December 2000

00S46

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 1999 and 2000 Explorer and Mountaineer vehicles equipped with 4.0L SOHC engines, built at the Louisville and St. Louis Assembly Plants.

What the safety issue is …

Although Ford does not advocate driving at vehicle maximum speed, the subject vehicles have a Powertrain Control Module (PCM) that may allow the vehicle to exceed the design intent top speed. At these extreme speeds, the vehicle may be capable of exceeding the maximum speed rating of the tires. Operating the vehicle above the tire maximum speed rating could lead to tire failure which at these extreme speeds could potentially result in an accident. Therefore, we are recommending that vehicles be returned to dealerships to have their Powertrain Control Module (PCM) updated with a revised calibration that will limit vehicle top speed to the intended design level.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

Ford Motor Company will update the Powertrain Control Module (PCM) calibration to limit the vehicle to the intended maximum speed.

This repair will be performed on your vehicle free of charge. Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for the (PCM) calibration update.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service appointment for Safety Recall 00S46.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 or 1-888-327-4863.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.



Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs